

of Sri Lanka's Dilhani Lekamge (58.98m). Seema Kaliramana threw 57.44m for fourth in the discus behind Brazil's Andressa de Moraes (58.66m). South Africa's Franco Le Roux won the men's 110m hurdles (13.47) and Kenya's Diana Wanza the women's 5000m (15:16.11).

For India, the meet was a diagnostic. Abinaya, Rohit, Vithya and Ancy gained momentum; Jyothi and Gurindervir now have repairs to make; Vishal left without racing. The evening awarded no medals, but clarified the road to Japan.

### **From Bronze to the World Indoors**

Kalinga Stadium staged India's maiden Bronze-level Continental Tour meet in 2025 and graduated to Silver a year later. The upgrade brought Category B world-ranking points, stronger overseas opposition and a timely home examination before Japan. Kalinga hosted the 2017 Asian Athletics Championships and India's first National Indoor Championships on a 200m track in March 2026. Bhubaneswar will host the 2028 Asian Indoor Championships and World Athletics Indoor Championships. The latter will be India's first global athletics championship since the 2004 World Half Marathon Championships in New Delhi.

The Silver meet tested operations, athlete services and public appetite. Withdrawals thinned fields, but packed stands gave the night life, especially when Abinaya shared her celebration.

**Acing the show:** Rohit Yadav saved his best for his final throw, improving on the 87.05m he produced at June's Inter-State meet. His 87.68m effort secured the men's javelin gold and moved him to fourth on the world list this season, just behind Neeraj Chopra's 88.05m.

